

QUESTION 1**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: Coral reefs provide habitat for roughly one quarter of all known marine species. _____ the decline of coral reefs due to rising ocean temperatures threatens not just the corals themselves but the entire web of organisms that depend on reef ecosystems. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Furthermore,

B: For instance,

C: Thus,

D: Similarly,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 2 is a CONSEQUENCE of sentence 1's fact (reefs support many species, so their decline threatens that web). 'Thus' marks a result. 'Furthermore' merely adds; 'For instance' gives an example; 'Similarly' draws a parallel -- none signal cause-to-effect.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: The phrase 'blind as a bat' implies that bats cannot see. _____ most bat species possess functional eyes and can detect objects visually, though they rely primarily on echolocation for navigation. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: On the contrary,

C: Consequently,

D: For example,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 states a common belief; sentence 2 directly CONTRADICTS it. 'On the contrary' signals a reversal of what was just claimed. 'In addition' merely adds info without challenging it, 'Consequently' implies a result, and 'For example' introduces an illustration.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: The Silk Road was not a single route but an intricate network of overland and maritime paths connecting East Asia with the Mediterranean. Merchants carried more than just silk along these corridors. _____ spices, glassware, and precious metals were among the many goods exchanged across thousands of miles. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: As a result,

C: By contrast,

D: For example,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'More than just silk' is a general claim; spices, glassware, and metals are SPECIFIC INSTANCES of that claim. 'For example' introduces illustrations. 'As a result' wrongly implies the goods were a consequence, and 'By contrast' wrongly implies opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: To prepare a traditional Japanese tea ceremony, the host first cleans and arranges all the utensils. _____ the host heats water in an iron kettle and measures powdered green tea into each guest's bowl. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Next,

B: In other words,

C: However,

D: For instance,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The word 'first' in sentence 1 signals a SEQUENCE. 'Next' continues the order. 'In other words' restates (no restatement here), 'However' introduces a contrast (there is none), and 'For instance' gives an example (this is a second step, not an illustration).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Mercury completes an orbit around the Sun in approximately 88 Earth days, making its year the shortest of any planet in the solar system. _____ Neptune takes nearly 165 Earth years to complete a single orbit. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Therefore,

B: In comparison,

C: Likewise,

D: Furthermore,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage sets up two extremes -- the shortest orbit vs. the longest. 'In comparison' signals a measured CONTRAST between two data points. 'Likewise' implies similarity (but 88 days vs. 165 years is opposite), 'Therefore' implies result, and 'Furthermore' adds info without highlighting the comparison.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: Lake Baikal in Siberia contains roughly 20 percent of the world's unfrozen surface freshwater. Many species found in the lake exist nowhere else on Earth. _____ the Baikal seal is the only exclusively freshwater seal species in the world. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: Specifically,
- D: As a result,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Many species exist nowhere else' is a general claim; the Baikal seal is one SPECIFIC case. 'Specifically' narrows a broad statement to a concrete detail. 'By contrast' wrongly implies opposition, 'Nevertheless' implies concession, and 'As a result' implies causation.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: Many people assume that camels store water in their humps. _____ the humps are composed primarily of fat, which the camels metabolize for energy during long treks across arid terrain. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Similarly,

B: Therefore,

C: In addition,

D: However,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 states a misconception; sentence 2 provides the corrective FACT. 'However' introduces a contrast with the false belief. 'Similarly' implies agreement with the misconception, 'Therefore' implies the humps are a result of the assumption, and 'In addition' merely adds without correcting.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: Raw cassava contains compounds that can release cyanide when consumed. _____ communities that rely on cassava as a dietary staple have developed elaborate soaking and fermentation techniques to render the root safe for eating. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Accordingly,

B: For instance,

C: By contrast,

D: In addition,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The danger (cyanide) logically prompted the RESPONSE (safety techniques). 'Accordingly' signals an action taken in response to a stated condition. 'For instance' gives an example (but the techniques are a response, not an example of cyanide), 'By contrast' implies opposition, and 'In addition' merely adds.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: Linguist Noam Chomsky proposed that all human languages share a common underlying grammatical structure, which he called Universal Grammar. _____ cognitive scientist Steven Pinker has argued that the capacity for language is an innate biological trait shared across all human populations. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: However,

B: For example,

C: Similarly,

D: Instead,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Both Chomsky and Pinker argue that language has a UNIVERSAL, innate basis. 'Similarly' links parallel claims. 'However' wrongly implies they disagree, 'For example' wrongly makes Pinker an illustration of Chomsky, and 'Instead' implies replacement.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The archaeological site at Gobekli Tepe in southeastern Turkey has yielded monumental stone pillars dating to roughly 9500 BCE. _____ excavations at the site have uncovered elaborate animal carvings etched into the surfaces of the pillars. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Therefore,

B: In addition,

C: By contrast,

D: However,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 mentions pillars; sentence 2 adds carvings found on those pillars -- a second, parallel finding at the same site. 'In addition' correctly signals added information. 'Therefore' wrongly implies the carvings are a result of the pillars' age, and 'However'/'By contrast' wrongly imply opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: When bees visit flowers to collect nectar, pollen grains adhere to their bodies and are transferred to subsequent blossoms. _____ the plants are fertilized, enabling them to produce fruit and seeds. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: For instance,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: In comparison,
- D: As a result,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Pollen transfer (cause) leads to fertilization (effect). 'As a result' marks this cause-to-effect chain. 'For instance' treats fertilization as an example rather than a consequence, 'Nevertheless' implies something surprising, and 'In comparison' sets up a comparison that does not exist here.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: To measure the age of an archaeological timber, dendrochronologist Renata Sousa first collected core samples from the wood. The samples were then compared to a master tree-ring chronology spanning several centuries. _____ this analysis placed the construction date of the structure at approximately 1340 CE. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Ultimately,

B: By contrast,

C: Furthermore,

D: Similarly,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage walks through sequential steps ending in a final OUTCOME. 'Ultimately' signals the concluding result of a multi-step process. 'Furthermore' just adds info without marking a conclusion, 'By contrast' introduces opposition, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In workshops led by educator Marcus Hale, elementary school students practice sketching everyday objects from multiple angles before attempting more complex compositions. _____ Hale's students develop a strong sense of proportion and spatial awareness that carries over into later artistic projects. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: In doing so,

C: For example,

D: By contrast,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The students perform an action (sketching from multiple angles), and a result follows FROM that action. 'In doing so' links the method to its outcome. 'Nevertheless' implies a surprising result, 'For example' treats the outcome as an illustration, and 'By contrast' implies opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: Scientists had long assumed that deep-ocean trenches were essentially devoid of life because of the extreme pressure and absence of sunlight. _____ recent expeditions using remotely operated vehicles have documented thriving communities of microorganisms and invertebrates at depths exceeding 10,000 meters. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Therefore,
- B: Furthermore,
- C: Similarly,
- D: Still,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: An old assumption (no life) is CHALLENGED by new evidence (thriving communities). 'Still' concedes the assumption existed but introduces contradictory findings. 'Therefore' would mean the evidence supports the assumption (it does not), 'Furthermore' just adds, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: A calorie, in nutritional science, is a unit of energy that the body derives from food. _____ it represents the amount of heat needed to raise the temperature of one kilogram of water by one degree Celsius. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: Furthermore,

C: In other words,

D: By contrast,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Both sentences define the same concept in different terms -- one practical, one technical. 'In other words' signals a RESTATEMENT. 'Furthermore' adds new info (but this is the same info restated), 'Nevertheless' implies concession, and 'By contrast' implies opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: EASY**

PROMPT: The 2019 wildfire season in eastern Australia was among the most destructive on record, consuming millions of hectares of forest and displacing countless animal populations. _____ conservation efforts in the affected regions have continued, with ecologists working to restore habitats for species such as koalas and greater gliders. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: Therefore,

C: For example,

D: Likewise,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The destruction might suggest hopelessness, but conservation CONTINUES despite it. 'Nevertheless' marks this concession -- 'despite X, Y still happens.' 'Therefore' wrongly implies conservation is a result of destruction (it persists despite it), 'For example' treats conservation as an illustration, and 'Likewise' implies parallel.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Acoustic guitars produce sound when vibrating strings transmit energy through a wooden bridge into a hollow body, which amplifies the resonance. _____ electric guitars rely on magnetic pickups to convert string vibrations into electrical signals, which are then amplified electronically. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: By contrast,

B: Likewise,

C: In addition,

D: Ultimately,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The two sentences describe DIFFERENT mechanisms (wooden body amplification vs. electronic amplification). 'By contrast' highlights this opposition. 'Likewise' implies they work the same way, 'In addition' merely adds without noting the difference, and 'Ultimately' implies a conclusion.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Historian Claudia Vega's 2021 study demonstrated that indigenous trade networks along the Orinoco River were far more extensive than previously documented. _____ Vega's analysis of ceramic styles along the river's tributaries revealed that pottery techniques from the upper basin had spread more than 800 kilometers downstream by the fourteenth century. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: Furthermore,

C: Instead,

D: By contrast,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 makes a general claim (networks were extensive). Sentence 2 provides ADDITIONAL supporting evidence (ceramic analysis). 'Furthermore' adds corroborating detail. 'Nevertheless' implies the ceramic data contradicts the claim, 'Instead' implies replacement, and 'By contrast' implies opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In high-altitude environments, the air contains less oxygen per unit of volume than at sea level. _____ mountaineers who ascend rapidly often experience altitude sickness, a condition characterized by headaches, nausea, and impaired judgment. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Similarly,

B: In comparison,

C: Granted,

D: Consequently,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Less oxygen (cause) leads to altitude sickness (effect). 'Consequently' marks a direct RESULT. 'Similarly' implies a parallel (but these are linked by causation, not similarity), 'In comparison' sets up a data contrast, and 'Granted' introduces a concession.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Traditional ecological knowledge encompasses the environmental observations accumulated by indigenous communities over many generations. Such knowledge is increasingly recognized as a valuable complement to Western scientific methods. _____ Aboriginal Australians' controlled burning practices, developed over millennia, are now studied by fire ecologists seeking to reduce the severity of uncontrolled bushfires. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: However,

B: In other words,

C: For instance,

D: Consequently,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The general claim is that traditional knowledge complements Western science. Aboriginal burning practices are a SPECIFIC CASE illustrating that claim. 'For instance' introduces an example. 'In other words' would restate the same idea, 'However' introduces opposition, and 'Consequently' implies burning practices are a result of the recognition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Architect Zaha Hadid was celebrated for incorporating sweeping curves and fluid geometries into her building designs. _____ fellow architect Santiago Calatrava has long favored organic, curvilinear forms inspired by the skeletal structures of birds and other animals. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Likewise,
- C: Therefore,
- D: For example,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Both architects favor curved, organic forms -- they share a PARALLEL approach. 'Likewise' connects similar practices. 'By contrast' wrongly implies their styles differ, 'Therefore' wrongly implies Calatrava's style results from Hadid's, and 'For example' wrongly makes Calatrava an instance of Hadid's approach rather than a peer.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: In a given rock formation, a layer of Devonian limestone from 380 million years ago might directly abut a band of Jurassic sandstone from 160 million years ago, with hundreds of millions of years of material missing in between. _____ time did not stand still during these intervening periods; the unaccounted-for sedimentary material was likely removed from the geological record by erosion. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: For example,

C: Meanwhile,

D: Of course,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage anticipates a reader's possible misunderstanding (that time was simply 'missing') and preemptively acknowledges an OBVIOUS POINT before clarifying. 'Of course' marks something self-evident. 'In addition' just adds info, 'For example' gives an instance, and 'Meanwhile' implies concurrent events.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Early astronomers assumed that all celestial bodies orbited Earth in perfect circles. After analyzing decades of precise observational data, Johannes Kepler concluded that planetary orbits are not circular. _____ he proposed that planets follow elliptical paths, with the Sun positioned at one focus of the ellipse. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Instead,

B: Similarly,

C: In addition,

D: Nevertheless,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Kepler rejected circles and REPLACED them with ellipses. 'Instead' marks a substitution -- not X, but Y. 'Similarly' implies ellipses are like circles, 'In addition' merely adds without replacing, and 'Nevertheless' implies the elliptical proposal came despite something (but it came because of the data).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: The Brazilian Atlantic Forest is one of the most biodiverse ecosystems on the planet, harboring an extraordinary concentration of species found nowhere else. _____ the forest is home to more than 260 endemic amphibian species, a figure that exceeds the total amphibian diversity of most entire countries. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: However,
- B: As a result,
- C: Specifically,
- D: Similarly,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The general claim is 'extraordinary concentration of species found nowhere else.' The 260-amphibian figure NARROWS that claim to one concrete detail. 'Specifically' zooms in from broad to precise. 'However' implies contrast, 'As a result' implies causation, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel to something else.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Clinical trials conducted by immunologist Priya Chakravarti demonstrated that the experimental vaccine produced a robust antibody response in more than 90 percent of participants. _____ the pharmaceutical company accelerated its timeline for seeking regulatory approval. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: For instance,

C: By contrast,

D: Accordingly,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Strong trial results (cause) led to an accelerated timeline (effect). 'Accordingly' means 'in response to these findings.' 'Nevertheless' implies the acceleration happened despite the results (nonsensical), 'For instance' treats the acceleration as an example, and 'By contrast' implies opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Many consumers believe that organic farming methods are always more environmentally sustainable than conventional agriculture. _____ some studies have found that organic farms can require significantly more land to produce the same quantity of food, potentially driving deforestation in land-scarce regions. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: On the other hand,

B: Similarly,

C: As a result,

D: In addition,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 states a popular belief; sentence 2 presents a COUNTERPOINT challenging it. 'On the other hand' introduces the opposing side of an argument. 'Similarly' implies agreement with the belief, 'As a result' makes the land-use problem a consequence of the belief, and 'In addition' adds without countering.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Antarctic ice sheet contains roughly 26.5 million cubic kilometers of ice, representing the largest single mass of ice on Earth. _____ the ice sheet holds approximately 70 percent of all freshwater on the planet, meaning that its partial melting could dramatically raise global sea levels. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: However,

B: Moreover,

C: Instead,

D: For example,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 gives one impressive fact; sentence 2 ADDS another impressive fact about the same subject. 'Moreover' builds on the first point with additional emphasis. 'However' introduces contrast (there is none), 'Instead' implies replacement, and 'For example' treats the freshwater stat as an illustration rather than an additional claim.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_Writing

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Renaissance painters developed numerous techniques for creating the illusion of three-dimensional space on flat surfaces. _____ the use of linear perspective, in which parallel lines converge toward a vanishing point on the horizon, allowed artists like Filippo Brunelleschi to depict architectural interiors with unprecedented spatial accuracy. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: On the contrary,

B: Therefore,

C: In particular,

D: Similarly,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Numerous techniques' is the broad claim; linear perspective is one SPECIFIC technique singled out. 'In particular' highlights a notable example from a larger set. 'On the contrary' introduces opposition, 'Therefore' implies a result, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel that is not present.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: To assess the structural integrity of the medieval bridge, engineer Tomoko Fujimura first conducted a visual survey of the stonework, noting areas of visible deterioration. _____ her team used ground-penetrating radar to identify internal fractures that were not visible from the surface. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Subsequently,

B: However,

C: In other words,

D: For example,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'First' signals a sequence -- the visual survey came first, then the radar scan followed. 'Subsequently' marks the NEXT STEP in a process. 'However' implies the radar contradicted the survey, 'In other words' restates, and 'For example' treats the radar as an illustration rather than a sequential action.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 30**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: The volcanic island of Surtsey, which emerged from the North Atlantic in 1963, has been closed to the public since its formation to preserve its value as a natural laboratory. Harsh conditions on the island -- persistent winds, sparse soil, and salt spray -- might seem inhospitable to plant life. _____ more than 70 vascular plant species have been recorded on Surtsey, many arriving as seeds carried by ocean currents and migratory birds. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Therefore,

B: Similarly,

C: In addition,

D: Nonetheless,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage sets up an expectation (harsh = no plants), then OVERTURNS it (70+ species thrive). 'Nonetheless' signals this concession: 'Despite seeming inhospitable, plants arrived.' 'Therefore' would mean plants grew because of harsh conditions (illogical), 'Similarly' draws a parallel, and 'In addition' just adds.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: It is tempting to assume that the novels of Haruki Murakami and Banana Yoshimoto serve the same primary purpose -- to entertain -- because both feature surreal plotlines. _____ Yoshimoto's fiction centers just as much on the emotional architecture of grief and recovery as it does on captivating readers with unusual narratives. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Furthermore,

B: In reality,

C: For instance,

D: Likewise,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'It is tempting to assume' signals a misconception. The sentence after the blank CORRECTS it. 'In reality' introduces the actual truth behind a false assumption. 'Furthermore' just adds, 'For instance' gives an example, and 'Likewise' agrees with the very assumption being corrected.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 32**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: The axolotl possesses the remarkable ability to regenerate entire limbs, portions of its spinal cord, and even parts of its heart and brain. _____ the species has become a model organism in regenerative medicine, with researchers studying its cellular mechanisms in the hope of developing therapies for human tissue repair. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: By contrast,

B: Regardless,

C: As a result,

D: Meanwhile,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The axolotl's regenerative ability (cause) led to its use in research (effect). 'As a result' marks a direct CONSEQUENCE. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'Regardless' implies the research happened despite something, and 'Meanwhile' implies unrelated simultaneous events.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Ancient Roman aqueducts relied solely on gravity to transport water, requiring engineers to calculate precise gradients over distances that sometimes exceeded 90 kilometers. _____ modern municipal water systems typically use electrically powered pumps that can push water uphill and through pressurized networks across varied terrain. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: By comparison,

B: In other words,

C: As a result,

D: Furthermore,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage juxtaposes two systems -- ancient vs. modern -- highlighting their different methods. 'By comparison' sets up a measured CONTRAST between two approaches. 'In other words' restates, 'As a result' implies modern systems arose because of Roman aqueducts, and 'Furthermore' adds without contrasting.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 34**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: Marine biologist Elena Marchetti sought to determine whether elevated noise levels from commercial shipping affected the feeding behavior of humpback whales in the Ligurian Sea. _____ she deployed underwater acoustic recorders at twelve sites along a major shipping lane and simultaneously tracked whale movements using satellite tags. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Likewise,
- C: Nevertheless,
- D: To that end,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 states a GOAL (determine noise effects); sentence 2 describes the METHOD used to achieve it. 'To that end' links a stated purpose to the action taken to fulfill it. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'Likewise' draws a parallel, and 'Nevertheless' implies the method was used despite something.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In 2018, archaeologists in Peru unearthed the remains of a pre-Incan irrigation system in the Lambayeque Valley. _____ a separate team working in southern Mexico documented a network of ancient raised-field farming platforms near the Grijalva River during the same excavation season. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Therefore,
- B: Meanwhile,
- C: For example,
- D: In other words,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two separate teams in different countries made discoveries during the SAME TIME PERIOD.

'Meanwhile' marks simultaneous but independent events. 'Therefore' implies Mexico's discovery resulted from Peru's, 'For example' treats Mexico as an illustration of Peru's finding, and 'In other words' restates.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The immune system relies on a complex interplay among many types of specialized cells. _____ macrophages engulf and digest foreign pathogens, while T cells identify and destroy the body's own infected cells. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: As a result,

C: For example,

D: By contrast,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Many types of specialized cells' is the general claim. Macrophages and T cells are SPECIFIC INSTANCES. 'For example' introduces concrete illustrations of the broader claim. 'Nevertheless' implies concession, 'As a result' implies causation, and 'By contrast' introduces opposition between the general and specific.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Critics initially praised director Amara Okonkwo's debut film for its inventive visual style and atmospheric cinematography. _____ several reviewers noted that the film's plot suffered from uneven pacing, particularly in its final act, where key narrative threads were left unresolved. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Similarly,
- B: Therefore,
- C: In addition,
- D: However,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 is positive (praise); sentence 2 is negative (criticism). 'However' marks this shift from a favorable to an unfavorable assessment. 'Similarly' implies the criticism matches the praise, 'Therefore' makes criticism a result of praise, and 'In addition' adds without noting the reversal in tone.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The boreal forests of Canada serve as one of the planet's most significant carbon sinks, absorbing billions of metric tons of carbon dioxide from the atmosphere. _____ these forests provide critical habitat for species such as the woodland caribou, whose migratory patterns span hundreds of kilometers of undisturbed forest. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: By contrast,

C: Instead,

D: Therefore,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 describes one function (carbon sink); sentence 2 describes ANOTHER function (habitat). Both are benefits of the same forest. 'In addition' signals a second, parallel point. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'Instead' implies replacement, and 'Therefore' implies habitat is a result of carbon absorption.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In the Northern Hemisphere, the Coriolis effect causes large-scale wind patterns to curve to the right relative to their direction of travel. _____ in the Southern Hemisphere, the same force deflects winds to the left, producing the mirror-image weather patterns observed in countries like Australia and Argentina. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Similarly,

B: Conversely,

C: In addition,

D: Therefore,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Right (North) vs. left (South) is a mirror-image REVERSAL of the same phenomenon. 'Conversely' signals an opposite but parallel relationship. 'Similarly' implies they curve the same way (they do not), 'In addition' just adds, and 'Therefore' implies the southern pattern is a consequence of the northern one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 40**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: Because peatlands accumulate organic matter faster than it decomposes, they sequester carbon over millennia, effectively locking it away from the atmosphere. When peatlands are drained for agriculture, however, the stored carbon is exposed to oxygen. _____ the carbon oxidizes and is released as carbon dioxide, transforming these former carbon sinks into significant sources of greenhouse gas emissions. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: For instance,
- C: As a result,
- D: Similarly,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Exposure to oxygen (cause) leads to carbon oxidation and CO₂ release (effect). 'As a result' links this cause-and-effect chain. 'By contrast' implies opposition between exposure and oxidation, 'For instance' treats oxidation as an example, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel that is not present.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 41**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: Philosopher Martha Nussbaum's capabilities approach argues that a just society should guarantee each citizen a minimum threshold of key human capabilities, such as bodily integrity and access to education. These capabilities are not merely theoretical abstractions. _____ they have been incorporated into the United Nations Human Development Index, which ranks countries based on measurable indicators of well-being. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: By contrast,

B: For example,

C: Instead,

D: Indeed,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Not merely theoretical' sets up an EMPHATIC CONFIRMATION that the capabilities are used in practice. 'Indeed' reinforces and strengthens the preceding assertion. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'For example' treats the UN Index as one illustration among many (but the passage uses it to prove the point, not illustrate it), and 'Instead' implies substitution.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 42

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Prolonged exposure to elevated levels of cortisol, the hormone released during periods of psychological stress, has been shown to impair the formation of new memories in the hippocampus. _____ individuals who experience chronic stress often report difficulty retaining new information and recalling recent events. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: As a result,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: By contrast,
- D: In comparison,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Cortisol impairs memory formation (cause) -- so stressed individuals have memory difficulty (effect). 'As a result' marks a direct consequence. 'Nevertheless' implies stress aids memory despite cortisol, 'By contrast' implies opposition, and 'In comparison' sets up a data contrast.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 43**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: Eighteenth-century taxonomist Carl Linnaeus classified whales as fish based on their aquatic habitat and streamlined body shape. Advances in comparative anatomy and embryology have since demonstrated that whales are mammals, possessing lungs, warm blood, and mammary glands. _____ some popular reference works continued to categorize whales alongside fish well into the nineteenth century. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Therefore,

B: Still,

C: Specifically,

D: In other words,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Science corrected the classification, but some references PERSISTED with the old one anyway. 'Still' signals that something continued despite evidence to the contrary. 'Therefore' implies the persistence was logical, 'Specifically' narrows a claim, and 'In other words' restates.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 44**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: When the volcanic island of Krakatoa erupted in 1883, it ejected an enormous volume of ash and sulfur dioxide into the stratosphere. The particulates circled the globe for months, scattering incoming sunlight and temporarily reducing average surface temperatures worldwide. _____ the eruption is considered one of the most influential volcanic events in the modern climate record. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: For instance,
- B: By contrast,
- C: For these reasons,
- D: In addition,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage details specific effects (ash, cooling) and then draws a CONCLUSION from them. 'For these reasons' signals a judgment based on the evidence just presented. 'For instance' treats the conclusion as an example, 'By contrast' implies opposition, and 'In addition' just adds without summarizing.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 45

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Traditional inkjet printers deposit liquid ink onto paper in fine droplets. _____ laser printers use a heated roller to fuse powdered toner onto the page, producing sharper text at higher speeds. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: Specifically,

C: Therefore,

D: In contrast,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Inkjet = liquid ink + droplets vs. laser = heated roller + toner. These are DIFFERENT METHODS for the same task. 'In contrast' highlights the difference. 'In addition' adds without contrasting, 'Specifically' narrows a general claim, and 'Therefore' implies laser printers are a result of inkjet technology.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 46

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Sociologist Fatima Al-Rashid found that multilingual children in Dubai frequently code-switch between Arabic and English within a single conversation, adapting their language to the social context of each exchange. _____ researcher Carlos Mendes observed the same pattern among Portuguese-Spanish bilingual adolescents in border towns along the Uruguay River. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Similarly,
- B: However,
- C: Instead,
- D: As a result,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Al-Rashid and Mendes each found the SAME PATTERN in different populations. 'Similarly' signals parallel findings. 'However' implies Mendes contradicted Al-Rashid, 'Instead' implies replacement, and 'As a result' implies Mendes's finding was caused by Al-Rashid's.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 47**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM**

PROMPT: Although the Amazon River basin is often described as an unbroken expanse of tropical forest, it actually comprises a mosaic of distinct habitat types. _____ seasonally flooded varzea forests differ sharply from the nutrient-poor blackwater igapo forests, and both contrast with the terra firme forests that never experience inundation. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: Specifically,

C: Therefore,

D: Nevertheless,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'A mosaic of distinct habitat types' is the general claim. The three named forest types NARROW that claim to concrete details. 'Specifically' zooms in from broad to particular. 'In addition' adds a new point rather than specifying, 'Therefore' implies these forests are a result, and 'Nevertheless' implies a concession.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 48

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Urban planner Jie Chen designed a pilot program in which neglected lots in downtown Suzhou were converted into pocket parks featuring native vegetation and permeable paving. _____ Chen's team not only reduced local flooding during the monsoon season but also increased neighborhood walkability scores by an average of 18 percent. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: In doing so,
- D: For instance,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The action (converting lots into parks) directly produced the results (less flooding, more walkability). 'In doing so' links the method to its outcomes. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'Nevertheless' implies the results were surprising or contrary, and 'For instance' treats the outcomes as examples rather than results of the action.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 49

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Poet Lucille Clifton's 1969 collection *Good Times* drew attention for its spare, unadorned verse about everyday Black life in urban America, a subject many critics considered too modest for serious literary treatment. _____ Clifton's work also extended a centuries-long tradition of using plainspoken language to illuminate the extraordinary within the mundane, a lineage traceable through Walt Whitman and Emily Dickinson. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: In spite of this critical attention,
- B: As a consequence of her stylistic restraint,
- C: Ultimately limited by its domestic scope,
- D: Beyond its thematic boldness,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 covers the thematic impact; the blank introduces an ADDITIONAL DIMENSION -- the literary-historical lineage. 'Beyond its thematic boldness' signals 'in addition to what was just discussed.' A implies Clifton ignored critics (not the point), B wrongly draws a causal link, and C concedes a limitation that the passage does not endorse.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 50**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Paleontologists studying fossilized tree resin, or amber, can sometimes identify insects that were trapped in the resin millions of years ago and preserved in extraordinary anatomical detail. Because the resin seals off the specimen from microbial decomposition, even delicate structures like wing venation and compound eyes remain intact. _____ amber does not preserve an organism's soft internal tissues or genetic material with the same fidelity, limiting the scope of biological questions that such fossils can answer. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: Of course,

C: Therefore,

D: For example,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: After describing amber's strengths, the passage ACKNOWLEDGES an obvious limitation. 'Of course' marks a point the reader might already expect -- a natural qualification. 'In addition' adds a second benefit (but this is a limitation), 'Therefore' implies the limitation follows from the preservation, and 'For example' treats the limitation as an illustration.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 51**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Economist Adaora Nwosu has argued that microfinance programs in sub-Saharan Africa have achieved measurable gains in household income for borrowers, particularly women in rural communities. The evidence supporting these gains, however, comes almost exclusively from short-term studies conducted within two years of initial lending. _____ Nwosu maintains that microfinance remains a critical tool for poverty reduction, provided that lenders adopt more rigorous long-term monitoring of borrower outcomes. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: For example,
- B: As a result,
- C: Nevertheless,
- D: In comparison,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage acknowledges a weakness (only short-term evidence), then signals that Nwosu STILL holds her position despite this limitation. 'Nevertheless' marks persistence through a concession. 'As a result' would mean Nwosu changed her view because of the limitation, 'For example' treats her maintained position as an illustration, and 'In comparison' sets up a contrast.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 52

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Because monarch butterflies require milkweed plants both as a food source for their larvae and as a site for egg deposition, the widespread loss of milkweed from agricultural landscapes in the central United States has sharply reduced the butterfly's reproductive success. _____ conservation organizations have launched campaigns to encourage homeowners, farmers, and municipal planners to plant native milkweed species along migration corridors. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In response,

B: By contrast,

C: Similarly,

D: In addition,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: A problem (milkweed loss) prompted an ACTION taken to address it. 'In response' signals a reaction to the situation just described. 'By contrast' implies the campaigns are opposite to the loss (they are a reaction, not an opposition), 'Similarly' draws a parallel, and 'In addition' adds without signaling the causal link between problem and action.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 53**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: The Doppler effect describes how the frequency of a wave changes relative to an observer who is moving toward or away from the wave source. When an ambulance approaches, its siren sounds higher in pitch; as it recedes, the pitch drops. _____ the perceived frequency increases during approach because successive sound waves are compressed into a shorter distance, and it decreases during recession because the waves are stretched apart. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: In addition,
- D: In other words,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 2 describes the everyday experience (siren pitch). The sentence after the blank RESTATES the same phenomenon in technical terms. 'In other words' signals a restatement or clarification. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'Nevertheless' implies concession, and 'In addition' adds new info (but this is the same info phrased differently).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 54**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: The temperate rainforests of New Zealand's South Island receive over 6,000 millimeters of annual precipitation, sustaining dense canopies of rimu, kahikatea, and other podocarp species. _____ the tussock grasslands of the island's eastern rain shadow receive fewer than 500 millimeters per year and support a completely different assemblage of drought-adapted plant communities. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Furthermore,

B: By contrast,

C: As a result,

D: Specifically,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 6,000 mm vs. fewer than 500 mm, dense canopies vs. drought-adapted grasslands -- these are sharp OPPOSITES. 'By contrast' highlights a measured difference. 'Furthermore' adds without noting the opposition, 'As a result' implies grasslands are caused by rainforests, and 'Specifically' narrows a general claim.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 55

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Novelist Yoko Tawada writes in both Japanese and German, producing separate bodies of work in each language rather than translating from one to the other. _____ Tawada has stated that each language generates its own distinct narrative possibilities, and that certain stories could only exist in the language in which they were conceived. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Indeed,

B: In addition,

C: By contrast,

D: Nevertheless,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 describes Tawada's practice (separate works per language). The sentence after the blank REINFORCES this by quoting her reasoning. 'Indeed' emphatically confirms and deepens the preceding point. 'In addition' merely adds, 'By contrast' implies opposition, and 'Nevertheless' implies her statement contradicts her practice.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 56

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Geologists have determined that the mantle plume beneath Iceland generates unusually high volumes of basaltic magma, which rises through the crust along the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. _____ Iceland experiences more frequent volcanic eruptions and possesses a thicker crust than other islands situated on mid-ocean ridges. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Similarly,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: For this reason,
- D: In comparison,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The mantle plume (cause) directly explains Iceland's frequent eruptions and thicker crust (effect). 'For this reason' marks a cause-to-effect link. 'Similarly' draws a parallel, 'Nevertheless' implies eruptions happen despite the plume, and 'In comparison' sets up a contrast that misses the causal connection.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 57

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Dead Sea Scrolls, discovered between 1947 and 1956, constitute one of the most important archaeological finds of the twentieth century. The collection includes more than 900 manuscripts spanning a wide range of genres and time periods. _____ some scrolls contain the oldest known copies of Hebrew biblical texts, while others preserve nonbiblical religious writings, community rules, and legal documents. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: As a result,

C: Instead,

D: Specifically,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'A wide range of genres' is the broad claim. Biblical texts, community rules, and legal documents are CONCRETE DETAILS specifying that range. 'Specifically' narrows from general to particular. 'Nevertheless' implies concession, 'As a result' implies causation, and 'Instead' implies replacement.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 58

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Despite documenting a statistically significant correlation between childhood musical training and enhanced verbal memory in adults, cognitive psychologist Lena Petersson cautioned that her study could not establish a causal relationship between the two variables. _____ Petersson noted that children who pursue sustained musical training may differ from their peers in preexisting cognitive ability, socioeconomic background, or parental involvement -- factors that could independently account for the observed memory advantage. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In particular,

B: By contrast,

C: Furthermore,

D: Similarly,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Petersson makes a general caution (no causal link), then SPECIFIES the confounding factors that justify that caution. 'In particular' zooms in on the specific reasons. 'By contrast' implies the confounders oppose the caution, 'Furthermore' adds a separate point, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 59

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Conservationist Rafael Herrera aimed to quantify the rate at which invasive lionfish populations were displacing native reef fish in the coastal waters off Belize. _____ he established a network of underwater survey stations at varying depths along the Mesoamerican Barrier Reef and monitored fish populations quarterly over a three-year period. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: To that end,
- C: In addition,
- D: Nevertheless,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 states a research GOAL; sentence 2 describes the method adopted to ACHIEVE that goal. 'To that end' connects purpose to action. 'By contrast' implies opposition, 'In addition' adds info without linking purpose to method, and 'Nevertheless' implies the method was adopted despite something.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 60

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Social psychologist Miriam Oduya hypothesized that employees who receive public recognition for their contributions would report higher levels of job satisfaction than those who receive equivalent financial bonuses in private. _____ her experimental data showed no significant difference in satisfaction between the two groups, suggesting that the social visibility of a reward matters less than its perceived fairness. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: In addition,
- B: For instance,
- C: However,
- D: Therefore,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The hypothesis predicted a difference; the data found NONE. 'However' marks a contrast between prediction and result. 'In addition' adds without flagging the mismatch, 'For instance' treats the data as an example, and 'Therefore' implies the null result supports the hypothesis (it contradicts it).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 61**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: The Rosetta Stone, inscribed in 196 BCE, presents the same decree in three scripts: hieroglyphic, Demotic, and ancient Greek. Because scholars in the early nineteenth century could already read ancient Greek, they used the Greek portion as a key to decipher the corresponding hieroglyphic characters. _____ the stone became the foundation upon which the entire modern understanding of Egyptian hieroglyphics was built. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: For example,
- D: Thus,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Scholars used Greek to decode hieroglyphics (cause), so the stone became foundational (effect). 'Thus' marks a logical CONSEQUENCE. 'By contrast' introduces opposition, 'Nevertheless' implies the result was unexpected, and 'For example' treats the foundational status as an illustration rather than a result.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 62**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Mycologist Kenji Watanabe discovered that the underground mycelial networks of certain fungal species facilitate the transfer of nutrients between trees of different species in temperate forests. Watanabe's research showed that older, well-established trees channel sugars through these fungal networks to younger, shaded seedlings that cannot photosynthesize enough to sustain themselves independently. _____ his team found evidence that the networks can transmit chemical warning signals, enabling neighboring trees to mount preemptive defenses against insect herbivores. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Furthermore,
- B: In other words,
- C: Nevertheless,
- D: Instead,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 2 describes one function (nutrient transfer). The sentence after the blank describes a SECOND, additional function (warning signals). 'Furthermore' adds a new finding on top of the first. 'In other words' restates, 'Nevertheless' implies the warning signals contradict the nutrient transfer, and 'Instead' implies replacement.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 63

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Many visitors assume that the vivid turquoise color of the water in Plitvice Lakes, Croatia, results from artificial dyes or mineral deposits. _____ the coloration is produced by a natural biochemical process: microorganisms in the lake precipitate dissolved calcium carbonate, forming travertine barriers that scatter light and create the distinctive blue-green hue. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: On the contrary,

C: Therefore,

D: Similarly,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Visitors' assumption (artificial cause) is directly CONTRADICTED by the truth (natural process). 'On the contrary' signals a sharp reversal of a stated belief. 'In addition' adds without correcting, 'Therefore' implies the biochemical process results from the assumption, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 64**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Anthropologist Sonia Mehra documented how the potlatch ceremonies of the Kwakwaka'wakw people of the Pacific Northwest serve as mechanisms for redistributing material wealth across extended kinship networks. _____ ethnographer David Holmberg observed that the jajmani system in rural Nepal also functions as an institutionalized framework for circulating resources among interconnected social groups, though through ongoing labor exchanges rather than periodic ceremonial events. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Therefore,

B: Instead,

C: Similarly,

D: In other words,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Both systems redistribute resources through social networks -- a PARALLEL function across different cultures. 'Similarly' links comparable practices. 'Therefore' implies Nepal's system resulted from the potlatch, 'Instead' implies replacement, and 'In other words' implies the jajmani system is just a restatement of the potlatch.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 65**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Over the course of a decade, civil engineer Amara Diallo and her team tested dozens of low-cost filtration materials -- including coconut shell charcoal, silica sand, and laterite clay -- for their ability to remove arsenic from contaminated groundwater in rural Senegal. Many materials showed promise in laboratory conditions but degraded rapidly when deployed in the field. _____ the team identified a composite filter combining laterite clay and iron-coated sand that maintained arsenic removal rates above 95 percent even after two years of continuous use. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Ultimately,

B: By contrast,

C: For instance,

D: In addition,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: After a long process of trial and failure, the passage arrives at a FINAL OUTCOME. 'Ultimately' signals the concluding result of an extended effort. 'By contrast' only compares without marking resolution, 'For instance' treats the success as one example among many, and 'In addition' adds without indicating finality.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 66**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: The cognitive phenomenon known as inattentional blindness occurs when a person fails to perceive a fully visible object because their attention is directed elsewhere. The phenomenon has been demonstrated across many sensory modalities and experimental conditions. _____ in the classic 'invisible gorilla' experiment designed by Christopher Chabris and Daniel Simons, roughly half of participants watching a video of people passing a basketball failed to notice a person in a gorilla suit walking through the scene. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: By contrast,

B: As a result,

C: Nevertheless,

D: In particular,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Many sensory modalities and experimental conditions' is the general claim. The gorilla experiment is a single, NOTABLE CASE singled out. 'In particular' highlights one standout example from a larger set. 'By contrast' implies the experiment contradicts the broader pattern, 'As a result' implies causation, and 'Nevertheless' introduces concession.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 67**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Critics have argued that automated essay-scoring software cannot evaluate the originality or persuasiveness of a student's argument and therefore should not be used as a substitute for human grading. Proponents counter that the software excels at detecting mechanical errors in grammar and syntax, tasks at which even experienced human graders can be inconsistent. _____ many composition instructors have opted for a hybrid approach, using the software to flag surface-level errors while reserving holistic evaluation of content and argument for human reviewers. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In other words,

B: Accordingly,

C: Similarly,

D: Instead,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two competing views are presented, and then instructors adopt a PRACTICAL COMPROMISE that responds to both. 'Accordingly' means 'in line with these considerations.' 'In other words' restates rather than resolves, 'Similarly' draws a parallel, and 'Instead' implies the hybrid replaced one side rather than reconciling both.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 68

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In arid environments, the rate of evaporation from open reservoirs can exceed the rate of inflow from tributary streams, gradually concentrating dissolved salts in the remaining water. _____ the Great Salt Lake has experienced a dramatic increase in salinity over the past century, as decades of upstream water diversion have reduced inflow while persistent evaporation has continued to shrink the lake's surface area. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: For instance,
- D: Similarly,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Sentence 1 describes a general process in arid environments. The Great Salt Lake is a SPECIFIC CASE that illustrates that process. 'For instance' introduces a concrete example. 'By contrast' implies the lake contradicts the general process, 'Nevertheless' implies the lake defies the pattern, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel without the general-to-specific narrowing.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 69

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Historian Amelia Thornton's 2023 monograph focuses on the diplomatic correspondence exchanged between the courts of Joseon Korea and Tokugawa Japan during the seventeenth century. _____ economist Ryo Matsuda's concurrent study analyzes the commercial trade records between the same two polities during an overlapping time period, offering a complementary economic perspective on their bilateral relationship. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Meanwhile,

B: Therefore,

C: In other words,

D: Specifically,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two scholars conducted SIMULTANEOUS but independent studies on related topics. 'Meanwhile' signals concurrent, separate activities. 'Therefore' implies Matsuda's study was caused by Thornton's, 'In other words' implies they are saying the same thing, and 'Specifically' narrows rather than introduces a parallel event.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 70**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: The James Webb Space Telescope can detect infrared light emitted by objects more than 13 billion light-years away, capturing radiation from some of the earliest galaxies to form after the Big Bang. The telescope's sensitivity is not accidental. _____ its 6.5-meter primary mirror, composed of 18 gold-coated beryllium segments, was engineered specifically to collect the faint, redshifted light that older, more distant objects emit. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: By contrast,

C: For example,

D: Indeed,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Not accidental' sets up an emphatic point: the design was deliberate. 'Indeed' reinforces and deepens this assertion with evidence. 'Nevertheless' implies the design contradicts the sensitivity, 'By contrast' introduces opposition, and 'For example' treats the mirror as one illustration rather than proof of intentional engineering.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 71

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: By coating the interior walls of hospital rooms with a copper alloy shown to eliminate more than 99 percent of bacterial colonies within two hours of contact, infection control specialist Dr. Nadia Khoury reduced hospital-acquired infection rates in her pilot ward by 40 percent over a twelve-month period. _____ Khoury demonstrated that a relatively simple material intervention could meaningfully supplement the hand-hygiene protocols that form the traditional backbone of infection prevention. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: In doing so,

C: For instance,

D: By contrast,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The action (coating walls) and the demonstration (simple interventions can supplement hygiene protocols) are linked by METHOD and OUTCOME. 'In doing so' connects a specific action to its broader significance. 'Nevertheless' implies the demonstration happened despite the coating, 'For instance' treats the demonstration as an example, and 'By contrast' introduces opposition.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 72

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: In pre-industrial Europe, textile production was a labor-intensive, decentralized process in which individual spinners and weavers worked from their homes using hand-operated equipment. _____ the advent of mechanized spinning mills in the late eighteenth century concentrated production in large factories, fundamentally altering the social organization of labor and accelerating urban migration. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Likewise,

B: In addition,

C: By contrast,

D: For example,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Pre-industrial (home-based, decentralized) vs. industrial (factory-based, concentrated) -- these are sharply DIFFERENT systems. 'By contrast' highlights the shift. 'Likewise' implies the factory system was similar, 'In addition' adds without noting the transformation, and 'For example' treats industrialization as an illustration of pre-industrial methods.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 73**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Ornithologist Wei Lin observed that migrating Arctic terns consistently adjusted their flight altitude in response to prevailing headwind speeds, climbing to higher altitudes where wind resistance was lower and descending when tailwinds at lower altitudes became favorable. _____ the birds were able to minimize energy expenditure during their 70,000-kilometer round-trip migration, the longest annual migration of any known animal species. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: In this way,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: In comparison,
- D: For instance,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The altitude adjustments (method) led to minimized energy expenditure (result). 'In this way' connects a described strategy to its achieved outcome. 'Nevertheless' implies the result was unexpected, 'In comparison' sets up a data contrast, and 'For instance' treats energy savings as an example rather than the result of the strategy.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 74**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Literary scholar Fatima Said has argued that Gabriel Garcia Marquez's frequent use of hyperbole and temporal distortion in his fiction reflects a deliberate effort to reproduce the nonlinear, communal storytelling traditions of Caribbean oral culture. Said acknowledges that some critics view these techniques as purely European-derived modernist devices. _____ she contends that the specific ways in which Garcia Marquez deploys exaggeration -- embedding it within multigenerational family sagas rather than stream-of-consciousness monologues -- aligns far more closely with oral narrative conventions than with the formal experiments of James Joyce or Virginia Woolf. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: Similarly,

C: For example,

D: Still,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Said acknowledges a counterargument (critics call it European modernism), then PUSHES BACK with her own reasoning. 'Still' signals persistence: 'despite what critics say, she maintains her position.' 'In addition' adds without countering, 'Similarly' draws a parallel, and 'For example' treats her argument as an illustration.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 75

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Popular accounts of the Scientific Revolution often portray it as a swift intellectual rupture with medieval thought -- a sudden awakening in which European scholars rejected centuries of Aristotelian dogma in favor of empirical observation. _____ the transition was far more gradual and contested than this narrative suggests; many natural philosophers of the sixteenth and seventeenth centuries continued to rely on Aristotelian frameworks even as they incorporated new experimental methods into their research. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Similarly,
- B: In reality,
- C: As a result,
- D: In addition,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Popular accounts portray it as X' sets up a common narrative. The sentence after the blank CORRECTS that narrative with the more nuanced truth. 'In reality' signals the shift from popular belief to actual fact. 'Similarly' implies agreement with the popular view, 'As a result' implies the gradual transition was caused by the popular portrayal, and 'In addition' adds without correcting.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 76**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Evolutionary biologist Marta Kovacs proposed that the bright plumage of male birds of paradise functions primarily as an honest signal of genetic fitness, because only males in peak physical condition can sustain the metabolic cost of producing such elaborate feathers. _____ the male Wilson's bird of paradise maintains an iridescent blue-green breast shield that requires continuous feather maintenance and high carotenoid intake, traits associated with strong immune function. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: By contrast,
- B: Nevertheless,
- C: For instance,
- D: Therefore,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Kovacs makes a general claim (bright plumage = fitness signal). Wilson's bird of paradise is a SPECIFIC CASE supporting that claim. 'For instance' introduces a concrete example. 'By contrast' implies Wilson's bird contradicts the theory, 'Nevertheless' implies the bird defies expectations, and 'Therefore' implies Wilson's bird is a consequence of the theory rather than evidence for it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 77**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: The 1923 Great Kanto Earthquake devastated Tokyo and Yokohama, killing more than 100,000 people and destroying over half a million structures. The disaster prompted sweeping changes to Japanese building codes, introducing requirements for reinforced concrete construction and wider firebreaks between buildings. _____ the psychological and cultural aftershocks of the earthquake -- including widespread scapegoating of ethnic minorities -- left scars that no amount of structural engineering could address. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Even so,

B: Therefore,

C: In addition,

D: For example,

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Building codes were improved (a positive response), BUT psychological scars remained (a problem beyond engineering's reach). 'Even so' concedes the progress while introducing a limitation that persists despite it. 'Therefore' implies the scars were caused by the building codes, 'In addition' adds without noting the tension, and 'For example' treats the scars as an illustration of the code changes.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 78

SECTION: READING_Writing

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Standard economic models predict that consumers will allocate their spending rationally, purchasing goods that maximize their utility relative to cost. _____ behavioral economist Nkechi Udom found that shoppers consistently overpaid for products labeled 'artisanal' even when blind taste tests revealed no perceptible quality difference from mass-produced alternatives. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

- A: Similarly,
- B: In addition,
- C: As a result,
- D: Conversely,

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Rational prediction (models say consumers optimize) vs. irrational behavior (consumers overpay for labels). 'Conversely' marks this sharp REVERSAL between theory and observed reality. 'Similarly' implies Udom's findings match the models, 'In addition' adds without highlighting the contradiction, and 'As a result' implies overpaying is a consequence of rational models.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 79**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Rather than treating the cave paintings at Lascaux as static images intended merely to decorate subterranean walls, archaeologist Claire Dubois has argued that the paintings were designed to interact with the natural contours of the rock surface. _____ a bison figure in the Hall of the Bulls is positioned so that a natural limestone ridge forms the animal's spine, suggesting that the Paleolithic artists deliberately incorporated geological features into their compositions. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nevertheless,

B: For instance,

C: By contrast,

D: Similarly,

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Dubois makes a general claim (paintings interact with rock contours). The bison figure is a SPECIFIC CASE demonstrating that claim. 'For instance' introduces a concrete example supporting the argument. 'Nevertheless' implies the bison contradicts the claim, 'By contrast' introduces opposition, and 'Similarly' draws a parallel to a separate argument.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 80**SECTION: READING_WRITING****CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Transitions****DIFFICULTY: HARD**

PROMPT: Physicist Hiroshi Tanaka demonstrated that superconducting materials, when cooled below their critical temperature, expel all internal magnetic fields in a phenomenon known as the Meissner effect. This property might seem to suggest that superconductors are entirely incompatible with magnetism. _____ the Meissner effect is precisely what enables magnetic levitation: by repelling external magnetic fields, a superconductor can suspend a magnet in midair indefinitely, a principle now being explored for frictionless transportation systems. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Similarly,

B: In addition,

C: On the contrary,

D: As a result,

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Might seem to suggest incompatibility' sets up a FALSE impression. The reality is the OPPOSITE -- the Meissner effect enables levitation, not incompatibility. 'On the contrary' signals that reality directly contradicts what 'might seem' true. 'Similarly' agrees with the false impression, 'In addition' adds, and 'As a result' implies levitation is a consequence of incompatibility.

END QUESTION